thermometer early in the morning seldom standing much above zero of Faren[t]. A poor fellow arrived the other day with the fingers of one hand frozen, they were a mass of matter and I suppose the first joints will drop off. We have not much snow here, indeed the snow is never very deep about Tabreez except in the drifts and on the hills, perhaps a great part of the plain being salt and the rest stoney may account in some measure for the snows not remaining. I hear that the snow is very deep about our villages and the wolves are committing great ravages, they have carried off half the dogs belonging to Kara Chibuk, they prowl about the village and if they can find a dog alone they sieze him carry him off tear him in pieces and eat him. A man took a cow out to water and was attacked by four wolves he ran one way and the cow the other both however got off scathless, except that the cow lost the end of her tail which the brutes tore off. Perhaps the most extraordinary thing about these animals is their strength of jaw. Some years ago I had a greyhound who had his side ripped open by a single bite, and I recollect seeing a tame wolf here who used to crunch mutton bones as we do radishes. Several men have been eaten by them in the Maranghd district, but none thank God from our villages. I have known much colder weather here, for in the winter of '45 the thermometer went as low as twenty degrees below zero, but I never recollect the hard weather being of such continuance and without a change. The snow fell in the middle of November and we have had slight falls dull cloudy weather and wind and drifts with little intermission ever since. In the mean time I continue to wage war upon the ducks with pretty good success; the other day I was out shooting and I shot two right and left — one fell into the pond on which they had been swimming and my pointer Juno who retrieves pretty well, did not like to go into the water to bring it out but went barking round the side. I however was not going to lose my duck, and so I made madam Juno do her duty and pushed her into the water. She brought out the duck but as soon as she had come out every hair was like a seperate icicle, and she looked something like a dog of frosted silver. She is too thin skinned and delecate for this winter work and sometimes I have had to put her on a horse to carry her home when she has been much in the water. The water of these ponds, coming from under ground immediately into the pond never freezes in the hardest weather, and they are consequently the resort of the ducks at this season.

The Prince has at length determined to have the Turkish work on Geography translated and we have already set about it, many things will of course have to be altered, as the book was written above a hundred years ago, but it is a good work, and by correcting it with the most modern Gazeteers I can find, I hope to make a creditable thing of it. His fondness for natural history is most amusing. I believe I told you that I have already translated for him, the history

Generated on 2020-09-16 01:40 GMT / https://hdl.handle.net/2027/mdp.39015035112419
Public Domain, Google-digitized / http://www.hathitrust.org/access_use#pd-google
Digitized by Google
Original from UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN